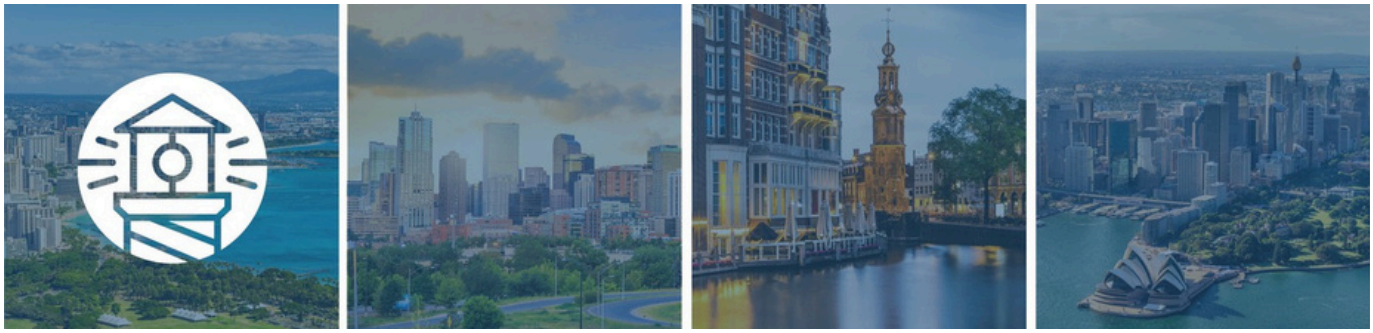

ML Engineer

Your interview journey with FareHarbor

We hope you had a good time meeting our team in the first round of interviews, and that they could provide a clear overview about our company! We are happy to move you forward to the next stage of our recruitment process.

This document will help you understand our interview stages and align them with your expectations. Hopefully this will help you to prepare and have a successful experience with us!

In this document you will learn about our interview stages, know more about what to expect and what is expected from you in each stage!

What are the interview stages?

After you meet with our recruitment team, they will reach out to you regarding the next steps—each stage depends on the outcome of the one before. To help you prepare, feel free to use this document as your roadmap through the process.
If you have any questions or need clarification at any point, please don't hesitate to reach out to your recruiter—we're here to support you every step of the way.

Interview steps are:

1. Round1(on line): Lightweight ML & Python Screen
2. Round 2 (on line): Hiring Manager interview
3. Round 3 (in-person): Practical ML & Pricing Interview, And wrap-up

After completing all interviews, all engineers involved will meet to discuss their feedback and decide on your application. Our recruiters will communicate the results to you as soon as they have this information.

How do we do that?

We aim to complete the process in maximum 3 weeks (depending on your and the team's availability).

During your interview we will not only assess your competencies and skills against our requirements for the role, but also ensure that we are aligned when it comes to work environment, work style, values, and more! This will take place across all interview rounds.

We are also always looking for new team members that will add to our incredible culture. But what is our FareHarbor culture? I recommend you to check out Boarding Pass to get a better understanding of our values

Round-1 (on line)

1. Coding: What to expect in this interview? (60 min)

Format: Live coding + discussion
Tooling: Collaborative coding environment (e.g., CoderPad) shared during a Google Meet.

What to expect:

- Short introductions and context.
- A live coding exercise that checks your general Python coding skills and your ability to solve a small ML-related problem.
- Follow-up questions to explore trade-offs, complexity, evaluation metrics and robustness
- Time for your questions at the end

Tips for success:

- Talk through your reasoning as you code
- Think practically when approaching a Machine Learning problem
- Keep your code readable (naming, small functions) and handle edge cases

Interviewers will be assessing the following:

- Communication: can you explain your approach, including the WHY and HOW
- Iteration: feel free to start with a simplistic or brute force approach and iterate towards an optimal solution
- Code quality: clarity, structure, and correctness
- Pragmatism: anticipating likely bottlenecks and failure modes
- ML thinking: reasoning about data, evaluation metrics, and model or feature choices

Resources:

- Practice an easy-to-medium coding problem in Python with a bug-free solution
- Work with small datasets and be ready to discuss complexity
- Be prepared to apply supervised and unsupervised Machine Learning techniques in order to approach a problem
- Write code in a simple editor (CoderPad-style environment with syntax highlighting)

Round-2 (on line)

1. Hiring Manager: What to expect in this interview? (60 min)

In this interview you will be meeting the hiring manager for the vacancy you have applied for.
In this interview, we will assess:

- Motivation - Why do you want to work at FareHarbor? Why do you find it interesting to work in the ML/Pricing field?
- Communication - We expect you to effectively adjust your communication to be able to provide clear feedback. We expect you to provide concrete examples of how you communicated effectively or successfully in the past, and what you might have learned that changed or improved your approach.
- Technical background:
- Be prepared to discuss a technically challenging ML-related project that you personally worked on in the past (approaching problem, collaboration, business impact). What was the problem? How did you solve it? What challenges did you face? How do the relevant systems work? What was your personal contribution to this project?

Round-3 (in-person)

1. Practical ML & Pricing Interview: What to expect in this interview? (60 min)

Format: Collaborative whiteboard discussion (e.g., Miro or Excalidraw).

What to expect:

- A high-level, intentionally ambiguous problem related to ML, revenue, or market efficiency
- You will clarify requirements, propose an approach, and discuss trade-offs and edge cases
- We may cover both ML thinking (data/modeling/metrics) and production considerations (pipelines, monitoring, rollout)

Common themes:

- Framing: prediction vs optimization (or both)
- Metrics: revenue, conversion, utilization, margin
- Experimentation: A/B tests, segmentation, interpreting results and avoiding pitfalls
- Production: feature generation, inference service design, monitoring, drift, rollback strategies
- Applications of reinforcement learning methods and their evaluation

Tips for success:

- Ask clarifying questions early and state assumptions explicitly
- Talk through decisions (trade-offs, edge cases, constraints)
- Collaborate: it is OK to think aloud and ask questions if you do not know something immediately
- Time-box: know when to go deeper vs when to move on

2. Wrap-Up with the Hiring Manager (30 min)

The final interview is a wrap-up conversation with the hiring manager. This round is less about new assessment and more about closing the process for you as a candidate.

It's an opportunity to review anything that hasn't yet been covered, clarify expectations about the role, team, and ways of working, and discuss any open questions you might have.

You should feel free to ask about the team culture, growth opportunities, day-to-day responsibilities, and next steps in the process. This meeting is designed to make sure you have all the information you need to decide whether this role is the right fit for you.

Good Luck!